CHICAGO PARK DISTRICT

PARTNERSHIPS - ARCS PROGRAM

INTRODUCTION

The Chicago Park District welcomes and encourages partnerships that enhance and support our mission and programs. The mission of the Chicago Park District is to:

To give people of all ages, identities, and abilities access to quality recreation, wellness opportunities, and sustainable green spaces in every neighborhood.

OVERVIEW

ARCS partners and the Chicago Park District develop a mutually beneficial agreement that outlines programs and activities based on a rigorous proposal process. The process assesses the merits of the proposed activities for the Park District and determines to what extent the activities further the Park District's mission. If it is determined that there is significant value of the program to the Park District, ARCS partners may eligible for special ARCS fees, as outlined in the program guidelines.

This form is to be used to *establish or renew* a formal partnership agreement with individuals, businesses, nonprofits, or other community groups. Eligible programs include:

- **Athletic:** youth sport leagues, private schools use of athletic space
- **Resident:** nonprofits, associations, or agency seeking space to provide regular, ongoing programming that aligns with CPD's mission
- **Contractor:** organizations or businesses seeking to provide ***fee-based programs*** that align with CPD's mission.
- **Service Provider:** partner seeking to provide programs for park-driven programs and events for ***no fee for participants.***

All partners are required to provide proof of insurance. An application will not be considered complete without a Certificate of Insurance that names the Chicago Park District as additional insured.

- Proof of insurance: Please send a COI naming the Chicago Park District as additional insured. Please use our main address, 4830 S Western Ave, Chicago, IL 60609, for this purpose.

If approved, you will be notified and sent a partnership agreement outlining the activities, benefits, and payment required to proceed with the partnership.

Once completed, submit this form to partnerships.app@chicagoparkdistrict.com. Please allow a minimum of 30 days to approve your proposal. Some proposed activities may require more time to plan and approve.

TODAY'S DATE	ORGANIZATION NAME (AS LISTED ON THE COI)
10/19/2026	Ras Tafari Inc.
MAILING ADDRESS	WEBSITE
1401 E. 71st St., Chicago, IL 60619	selassiefest.com/full-spectrum/
CEO/OWNER NAME	CEO/OWNER PHONE
Stephen Henry, President	(872) 255-9333
CEO/OWNER EMAIL	
stephen@selassiefest.com	
CONTACT NAME	CONTACT PHONE
Stephen Henry	(872) 255-9333
CONTACT EMAIL	
stephen@selassiefest.com	

PARTNERSHIP NAME (PROGRAM/SERVICE/EVENT SERIES NAME)

Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach

TYPE OF PARTNERSHIP REQUESTED

Service Provider

Is your organization a 501c3 nonprofit, business, individual, or other community group?

(●) 501c3 nonprofit ( ) Business ( ) Individual ( ) Other Community Group

Do you have an existing relationship with a PAC, local park, or department of the Chicago Park District? If yes please list the name and title of your contact. Yes. Ivry Ector, Park Supervisor, Rainbow Beach Park

Brief Description of the Organization/Individual and the Purpose of the Proposed Partnership. (How do you describe your organization/self and this program in marketing materials and/or outreach?) 50 Words or Less.

Ras Tafari Inc. is a Chicago 501(c)(3) cultural and educational nonprofit and the producer of SelassieFest. Full Spectrum is our free, year-round music and culture program for Rainbow Beach Park: DJ classes, Rainbow Wednesdays youth DJ nights, live stage shows, festival days and fall and holiday family parties.

How does this proposed partnership align with or support the Chicago Park District mission? 50 Words or Less.

It gives people of all ages, identities and abilities free, quality arts and recreation in their own neighborhood park. South Shore families get the kind of music programming they now travel nine miles to Grant Park for, with free classes, loaned gear, ASL interpretation and accessible seating.

IMPACT AREA. Select all that apply. **Ctrl+Click**

- Arts/Culture
- Education
- Life Skills
- Recreation

Will your activities be open to the public? (●) Yes ( ) No

If no, please explain your process for how participants gain involvement in your activity.

PARK(S) WHERE PARTNERSHIP WILL TAKE PLACE:

Rainbow Beach Park, 3111 E. 77th St.

PROGRAM START DATE

1/1/27

PROGRAM END DATE

12/31/27

FACILITIES REQUESTED. SELECT ALL THAT APPLY.

Gymnasium - General	Outdoor Space - Other	Rooms - Dance
Gymnasium - Large	Rooms - Club	Rooms - Other

Please enter the total number of hours needed per day below.

SUN	MON	TUES	WED	THURS	FRI	SAT
			4			3

FOR MORE INFORMATION ABOUT THE SCHEDULE PLEASE DESCRIBE BELOW OR ATTACH A CALENDAR

Rainbow Wednesdays, on the beach (Outdoor Space - Other): 14 Wednesdays, June 2 to Sept. 1, 2027, 6:00 to 8:30 pm (5:00 to 9:00 pm with setup). DJ classes: one 90-minute class a week, day and room set with park staff. Black History Month: four Saturdays in Feb. Stage shows, festival days and holiday parties on dates set with park staff, each with its own permit. Calendar attached.

ARE YOU REQUESTING MARKETING MATERIAL POSTED IN THE PARK? SELECT ALL THAT APPLY.

Banners	Flyers	Other

OTHER PARK RESOURCES

Other marketing: online via Rainbow Beach Park & CPD; power, tables, chairs

Will you charge a fee for activities? ( ) Yes (●) No

If yes, please describe fee and amount.

Do any of your planned activities require a Special Event Permit? (●) Yes ( ) No

Are you requesting a discount for the Special Event Permit? (●) Yes ( ) No

Outline your activities in detail. Please include a description of the program, the purpose of the partnership, and how these activities enhance CPD's existing programs.

Full Spectrum is one free program in five parts; each starts only when funded and scheduled with park staff. (a) DJ classes: 14 weekly 90-minute sessions for ages 5 to adult (Guinness named DJ Arch Jnr the world's youngest club DJ at 5), gear provided, including a girls-only Empress Decks track taught by women DJs. (b) Rainbow Wednesdays: 14 free summer evenings of youth DJs and live instruments on the beach. (c) Live stage shows where young performers open for local and major artists. (d) Festival and heritage days, including Black History Month: all ages research history with AI, write songs, and DJs mix them into one set. (e) Fall, holiday and Valentine's parties, October to February. It adds evening and off-season arts programming at the park and gives young people a path from class to stage. Full proposal attached.

How are you or your organization qualified to lead these activities? 50 Words or Less.

Ras Tafari Inc. produces SelassieFest, Chicago's roots reggae and cultural festival, end to end: artist contracting, staging, sound, permits, insurance and marketing. Classes follow a written 14-session curriculum taught by experienced Chicago DJs, with professional sound from Q-Ality Sound under a vendor agreement.

Is this partnership a collaboration with an existing CPD program? If yes explain. 50 Words or Less.

Not yet formally. We would welcome linking Full Spectrum to Rainbow Beach Park's youth and teen programs, with class graduates DJing park events, day camp celebrations and holiday programs.

Describe the evidence of community demand for the proposed partnership. 50 Words or Less.

Interest in learning to DJ is rising: Pioneer DJ reported higher sales of its beginner controllers from 2020, and the DJ-gear market grows about 6 to 7% a year. South Shore families travel nine miles to Grant Park concerts. We will track registrations, Open Decks sign-ups and head counts.

Are you willing to offer programming at additional park location(s)? (●) Yes ( ) No

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Projected Number of Participants: 50+ youth

Gender(s): All genders; reserved seats for girls

Ages (Select all that apply.)

Early Childhood	Adults
Youth	Families
Teens	Seniors

Race/Ethnicity (Select all that apply): General Audience

Income levels (Select all that apply): General Audience

Community Area(s)

Avalon Park	South Chicago
Calumet Heights	South Shore
Greater Grand Crossing	Woodlawn

Veterans (●) Yes ( ) No

Disability (●) Yes ( ) No

LGBTQ (●) Yes ( ) No

Please review the ARCS Guidelines for details about required benefits for the partner type you are applying for and describe the benefits in detail that you are able to provide for the Chicago Park District.

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES (Include number of days, number of volunteers, and number of hours)

Rainbow Wednesdays: at least 2 volunteers each night for 14 nights, about 4 hours each (Open Decks sign-up, accessibility help, cleanup), alongside paid crew. Festival days and parties: volunteer crews sized per event. Every adult who works with young people passes CPD's volunteer background check.

IN-KIND SERVICES & CONTRIBUTIONS (Please discuss with Park Supervisor.) Include specifics such as number of service hours for park programs or field maintenance, etc.

Free classes and events for park patrons; program-owned DJ controllers, headphones and professional sound at no cost to the park; class students available to DJ park events on request; sites left cleaner than we found them.

OTHER BENEFITS

Year-round use of the park, including the off-season; a focus on girls, who hold under 6% of Hot 100 producer credits (USC Annenberg, 2024); veterans outreach led by board member and veteran Albert Harris; LGBTQ+ youth and families invited by name; ASL, accessible seating and a quieter zone; $1M general liability naming CPD; background checks for all adults working with youth; a season report to the park with attendance, performers and audience reach.

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS:

-Proof of insurance (required)
-References, Letters of Recommendation
-Certifications and proof of affiliation (letterhead, business card, etc.)
-Proof of nonprofit status
-Permit request
-Proposed schedule of activities with detailed descriptions
-Other:

SUBMIT COMPLETED APPLICATIONS TO
PARTNERSHIPS.APP@CHICAGOPARKDISTRICT.COM

PLEASE NOTE:

We will consider partnerships for parks across the city, but prioritize partnerships that support parks with specific programming needs as determined internally by the Chicago Park District. Please note that for ongoing partnerships, proposals must be submitted at least annually, unless partnership agreements allow for longer terms.

Ideal partnerships show an equal financial and programmatic impact on both the Chicago Park District and our partners. A series of events may be considered as part of a partnership agreement, but one-time events are not eligible for the ARCS program.

Department of the Treasury
Internal Revenue Service
Tax Exempt and Government Entities
PO Box 2508
Cincinnati, OH 45201

Date:
06/12/2026
Employer ID number:
42-3036705
Person to contact:
Name: D. Morgan
ID number: 0194954
Telephone: 877-829-5500
Accounting period ending:
December 31
Public charity status:
509(a)(2)
Form 990 / 990-EZ / 990-N required:
Yes
Effective date of exemption:
June 9, 2026
Contribution deductibility:
Yes
Addendum applies:
No

RAS TAFARI INC
765 E 154TH ST
SOUTH HOLLAND, IL 60473

Dear Applicant:

We're pleased to tell you we determined you're exempt from federal income tax under Internal Revenue Code (IRC) Section 501(c)(3). Donors can deduct contributions they make to you under IRC Section 170. You're also qualified to receive tax deductible bequests, devises, transfers or gifts under Section 2055, 2106, or 2522. This letter could help resolve questions on your exempt status. Please keep it for your records.

Organizations exempt under IRC Section 501(c)(3) are further classified as either public charities or private foundations. We determined you're a public charity under the IRC Section listed at the top of this letter.

If we indicated at the top of this letter that you're required to file Form 990/990-EZ/990-N, our records show you're required to file an annual information return (Form 990 or Form 990-EZ) or electronic notice (Form 990-N, the e-Postcard). If you don't file a required return or notice for three consecutive years, your exempt status will be automatically revoked.

If we indicated at the top of this letter that an addendum applies, the enclosed addendum is an integral part of this letter.

For important information about your responsibilities as a tax-exempt organization, go to www.irs.gov/charities. Enter "4221-PC" in the search bar to view Publication 4221-PC, Compliance Guide for 501(c)(3) Public Charities, which describes your recordkeeping, reporting, and disclosure requirements.

Sincerely,

Stephen A. Martin
Director, Exempt Organizations
Rulings and Agreements

RAS TAFARI INC.

An Illinois not-for-profit corporation · 501(c)(3) · EIN 42-3036705 · IL File #75598726
7700 S. Stony Island Ave., Chicago, IL 60649 · (872) 255-9333

UNANIMOUS WRITTEN CONSENT OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS IN LIEU OF A MEETING

Resolution 2026-10-15-01 · Chicago Park District ARCS Partnership Proposal: *Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach*

The undersigned, being all of the directors of Ras Tafari Inc., an Illinois not-for-profit corporation (the "Corporation"), act under Section 108.45 of the Illinois General Not For Profit Corporation Act of 1986 and consent to the following resolutions, with the same force and effect as a unanimous vote at a duly held meeting of the Board.

WHEREAS, the Corporation's purposes include community festivals, arts education and youth development (Bylaws, Art. II);

WHEREAS, the Chicago Park District's ARCS program forms partnerships with nonprofits that provide programs in its parks, and on October 14, 2026, the Rainbow Beach Park Supervisor told the Corporation to submit its proposal through that program;

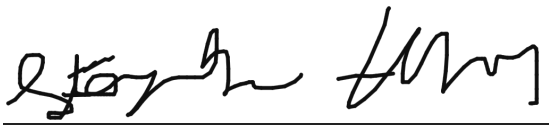
WHEREAS, on October 15, 2026, the directors reviewed the proposal in full, as recorded in the minutes of that date;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED:

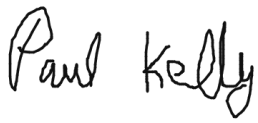
1. **Approval.** The ARCS Partnership Proposal for *Full Spectrum at Rainbow Beach*, a free program of the Corporation at Rainbow Beach Park, 3111 E. 77th St., Chicago, as a Service Provider partnership from January 1 to December 31, 2027, is approved substantially in the form the Board reviewed.
2. **Authority to submit.** Stephen Henry, President, is authorized to finalize, sign and submit the proposal and its supporting documents to the Chicago Park District, to answer its questions and to make non-material changes it asks for. The Corporation's contact number on the proposal is (872) 255-9333.
3. **Insurance first.** The proposal will not be submitted until the Corporation holds a Certificate of Insurance naming the Chicago Park District, 4830 S. Western Ave., Chicago, IL 60609, as additional insured, with general liability of at least $1,000,000 and sexual abuse and molestation coverage. The President may obtain quotes; any premium is paid under Article XI of the Bylaws.

4. **Background checks.** Every director, officer and volunteer who works with participants under 18 completes the Chicago Park District's volunteer background check before doing so.
5. **Free to participants.** No Full Spectrum activity charges participants a fee.
6. **Partnership agreement.** If the Chicago Park District approves the proposal, the President may negotiate its partnership agreement and will bring it to the Board for approval before it is signed.
7. **Ratification.** All earlier acts of the Corporation's officers in preparing this proposal are ratified and confirmed.
8. **Records.** The Secretary will file this consent with the minutes of October 15, 2026, in the corporate records book.

This consent may be signed electronically and in counterparts. It takes effect on the date the last director signs it.



Stephen Henry
President / Director
Signed electronically Oct 18, 2026, 3:35 PM CT



Paul Kelly
Vice President & Treasurer / Director
Signed electronically Oct 18, 2026, 2:22 PM CT



ALBERT HARRIS
Secretary / Director
Signed electronically Oct 16, 2026, 4:48 PM CT

SIGNATURE RECORD

Board approval of the CPD ARCS proposal (Oct. 15, 2026) · packet rti-arcs-2026-10-15 · completed Oct 18, 2026, 3:35 PM CT

Document fingerprint (SHA-256):
`f495967ca4530d893e987a8bf0c7655098ba65677a265d5dfff617b41c19371c`

Stephen Henry, President / Director

Signed	Oct 18, 2026, 3:35 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above

Paul Kelly, Vice President & Treasurer / Director

Signed	Oct 18, 2026, 2:22 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above

Albert Harris, Secretary / Director

Signed	Oct 16, 2026, 4:48 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above

RAS TAFARI INC.
An Illinois not-for-profit corporation · 501(c)(3) · EIN 42-3036705 · IL File #75598726
1401 E. 71st St., Chicago, IL 60619 · (872) 255-9333

UNANIMOUS WRITTEN CONSENT OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS IN LIEU OF A MEETING

Resolutions 2026-10-18-01 and 2026-10-18-02 · Program names and Attorney General registration

The undersigned, being all of the directors of Ras Tafari Inc., an Illinois not-for-profit corporation (the "Corporation"), act under Section 108.45 of the Illinois General Not For Profit Corporation Act of 1986 and consent to the following resolutions, with the same force and effect as a unanimous vote at a duly held meeting of the Board.

Resolution 2026-10-18-01 · Adoption and use of program names

WHEREAS, the Corporation carries out its exempt purposes through programs that are known to the public by their own names;

WHEREAS, the Corporation is registering with the Illinois Attorney General under the Charitable Trust Act and the Solicitation for Charity Act, and the registration statement (Form CO-1) asks for the names under which contributions are solicited and for documentation authorizing their use;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED:

1. **Names adopted.** The Corporation adopts, and authorizes its officers, volunteers and materials to use, the following names for its programs and for soliciting contributions, sponsorships and grants for those programs:
    1. **SelassieFest**, the Corporation's annual educational cultural heritage festival
    2. **Rainbow DJ Lab**, the Corporation's youth music and DJ education program
    3. **Full Spectrum**, the Corporation's community youth arts and music programming initiative
2. **Funds belong to the Corporation.** Every contribution, sponsorship, grant or other payment received under any of these names is the property of the Corporation, is deposited only in the Corporation's accounts, and is used only for the Corporation's exempt purposes under the direction of this Board. No program name is a separate organization, and no person may hold or spend funds raised under a program name outside the Corporation's accounts.
3. **Identification.** Solicitations and materials using a program name will, where practical, identify the program as "a program of Ras Tafari Inc."
4. **Assumed-name filings.** If the Illinois Secretary of State or any other agency requires an assumed-name filing for any of these names, the President or the Secretary is authorized to

make it and to pay the filing fee from the Corporation's funds.

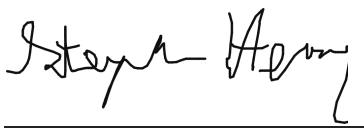
5. **Prior use ratified.** Any earlier use of these names on the Corporation's behalf since its incorporation on June 8, 2026, including any contributions received under them, is ratified and confirmed.
6. **New names.** Any additional program name used to raise funds must first be approved by the Board.

Resolution 2026-10-18-02 · Illinois Attorney General charitable registration

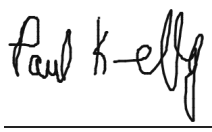
RESOLVED, that:

1. The Corporation registers with the Illinois Attorney General's Charitable Trust Bureau under both the Charitable Trust Act and the Solicitation for Charity Act.
2. **Stephen Henry**, as President, and **Paul Kelly**, as Vice President and Treasurer and chief fiscal officer, are each authorized to sign, on the Corporation's behalf, the Registration Statement (Form CO-1), the Financial Information form (Form CO-2) and any related certification, and to submit them with the Corporation's Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, IRS determination letter and this consent.
3. The Corporation pays the $15.00 registration fee, and any later annual report fees, from its funds.
4. The officers keep the registration current by filing the annual report (Form AG990-IL) within six months after each fiscal year ends on December 31.

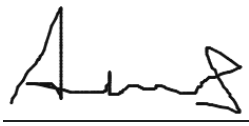
This consent may be signed electronically and in counterparts. It takes effect on the date the last of the three undersigned directors signs it. The Secretary will file it in the corporate records book.



Stephen Henry
President / Director
Signed electronically Oct 18, 2026, 8:47 PM CT



Paul Kelly
Vice President & Treasurer / Director
Signed electronically Oct 18, 2026, 2:25 PM CT



ALBERT HARRIS
Secretary / Director
Signed electronically Oct 18, 2026, 12:44 PM CT

SIGNATURE RECORD

Program names and Illinois Attorney General registration (Oct. 18, 2026) · packet rti-board-2026-10-18 · completed Oct 18, 2026, 8:47 PM CT

Document fingerprint (SHA-256):
`a4d301cfd4bffd91a745b2116ac3d4067f32c18b53bb26b6fce20ac0d1b7384a`

Stephen Henry, President / Director

Signed	Oct 18, 2026, 8:47 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above

Paul Kelly, Vice President & Treasurer / Director

Signed	Oct 18, 2026, 2:25 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above

Albert Harris, Secretary / Director

Signed	Oct 18, 2026, 12:44 PM CT
Conflict of interest	None disclosed
Fingerprint signed	Matches the document above